catch. When the *Daily Mirror* published his location, paps descended on his house, taunting him, trying to tempt or lure him outside. No fox hunt, no bear baiting was ever more depraved. Strange men and women dangled offers of money, gifts, friendship. When none of that worked, they rented the house next door and shot him day and night through his windows. The press reported that, as a result, Meg's father had nailed plywood over his windows.

But this wasn't true. He'd often had plywood nailed over his windows, even when living in Los Angeles, well before Meg started dating me.

Complicated man.

They'd then begun following him into town, tailing him on his errands, walking behind him as he went up and down the aisles of local shops. They'd run photos of him with the headline: GOT HIM!

Meg would often phone her father, urge him to remain calm. *Don't speak to them, Daddy. Ignore them, they'll go away eventually, as long as you don't react. That's what the Palace says to do.*

37.

IT WAS HARD for both of us, while dealing with all that, to focus on the million and one details of planning a royal wedding.

Strangely, the Palace had trouble focusing too.

We wanted to get married quickly. Why give the papers and paps time to do their worst? But the Palace couldn't seem to pick a date. Or a venue.

While waiting for a decree from on high, from the nebulous upper regions of the royal decision-making apparatus, we went off on a traditional "engagement tour." England, Ireland, Scotland, Wales—we traveled up and down and all over the UK, introducing Meg to the public.

Crowds went wild for her. *Meg, Diana would've loved you!* I heard women scream this again and again. A total departure from the tone and tenor of the tabloids, and also a reminder: the British press wasn't reality.

On our return from that trip I rang Willy, sounded him out, asked his thoughts about where we might get married.